National Health and Aging Trends Study (NHATS)

Round 1 Public Use Data – Final Release Version 4

README FILE

The NHATS R1 Public Use Final Release SAS Zip File contains 23 files (in addition to this README file). Files are described briefly below, with file names shown in **bold**.

SAS DATA FILES & FORMATS

Five SAS data files (version 9.4) are included:
NHATS_Round_1_SP_File.sas7bdat contains the sample person (SP) and the facility questionnaire (FQ) data (8,245 observations and 1,219 variables).
NHATS_Round_1_OP_File_V2.sas7bdat contains other person (OP) data (38,097 observations and 60 variables).
NHATS_Round_1_Tracker_File.sas7bdat contains tracking information for all persons sampled for NHATS (12,411 observations and 128 variables).
NHATS_Round_1_MetNonMet.sas7bdat contains metro/nonmetro geographic information for all persons who completed an NHATS interview (8,245 observations and 2 variables).
NHATS_Round_1_Int_Inc_Imp_File.sas7bdat contains the interval income imputation data (8,245 observations and 23 variables).
PROC FORMAT statements are provided in
NHATS_Round_1_Combined_PROC_FORMAT_Statement.sas for the first three files combined,
NHATS_Round_1_MetNonMet_PROC_FORMAT.sas for metro/nonmetro file, and
NHATS_Round_1_Int_Inc_Imp_PROC_FORMAT.sas for interval income imputation file. (Users who prefer to disable the formats may use the statement OPTIONS NOFMTERR.)

ASCII FIXED FORMAT TEXT FILES

Five ASCII files are included: **NHATS_Round_1_SP_File_V3.txt**, **NHATS_Round_1_OP_File_V2.txt**, **NHATS_Round_1_Tracker_File_V3.txt**, **NHATS_Round_1_MetNonMet.txt,** and **NHATS_Round_1_Int_Inc_Imp_File.txt**.
Users may create their own SAS file by reading in the ASCII files with the provided SAS program files:
NHATS_Round_1_SP_READ_V3.sas, **NHATS_Round_1_OP_READ_V2.sas**, **NHATS_Round_1_Tracker_READ_V3.sas**, **NHATS_Round_1_MetNonMet_READ.sas,** and **NHATS_Round_1_Int_Inc_Imp_Read.sas**.
Each SAS program contains four sections: (1) a section setting up the pre-defined formats, (2) an input statement, which identifies the starting position of each variable in the ASCII file, (3) a section mapping variables to specific formats, and (4) a section that provides descriptive variable labels, which can be mapped back to the Instrument. Alternatively, users may adapt these SAS programs as needed to import the ASCII data into other software packages.

CODEBOOK FREQUENCIES

Frequencies (and means for many continuous variables) are included in:
NHATS_Round_1_SP_Frequencies.pdf
NHATS_Round_1_OP_Frequencies_V2.pdf
NHATS_Round_1_Tracker_Frequencies.pdf
NHATS_Round_1_MetNonMet_Frequencies.pdf
NHATS_Round_1_Int_Inc_Imp_Frequencies.pdf
For each variable, the variable name and label is included along with value labels and associated numeric values.

ADDITIONAL DOCUMENTATION

Additional documentation is available on the NHATS website (www.NHATS.org) and includes: the Round 1 Instruments (annotated with variable names and labels), User Guide, Crosswalk between instrument items and codebooks, Crosswalk of changes between the Round 1 Beta release and Round 1 Final release, and various technical papers.

CHANGES TO OP FILE IN FINAL RELEASE, VERSION 2

Several updates have been made to the OP file

- Fixed a coding error in op1dhrsmth
- Recoded op1prsninhh to 2 (no) from inapplicable (-1) if proxy respondent other than a spouse (relationship NE to 2) and SP has facility flag set to 1 (n = 59)
- Recoded op1chnotinhh to 1 (yes) from inapplicable (-1) if proxy respondent and relationship is 3 or 4 (son or daughter) and SP has facility flag set to 1 (n = 36)
- Fixed data entry error for 2 SPIDs and 4 OPIDs on op1dage and op1dcatgryag

QUESTIONS OR COMMENTS

If you have questions or concerns that are not addressed here or in documentation found at www.NHATS.org, please feel free to contact us at NHATSdata@westat.com.